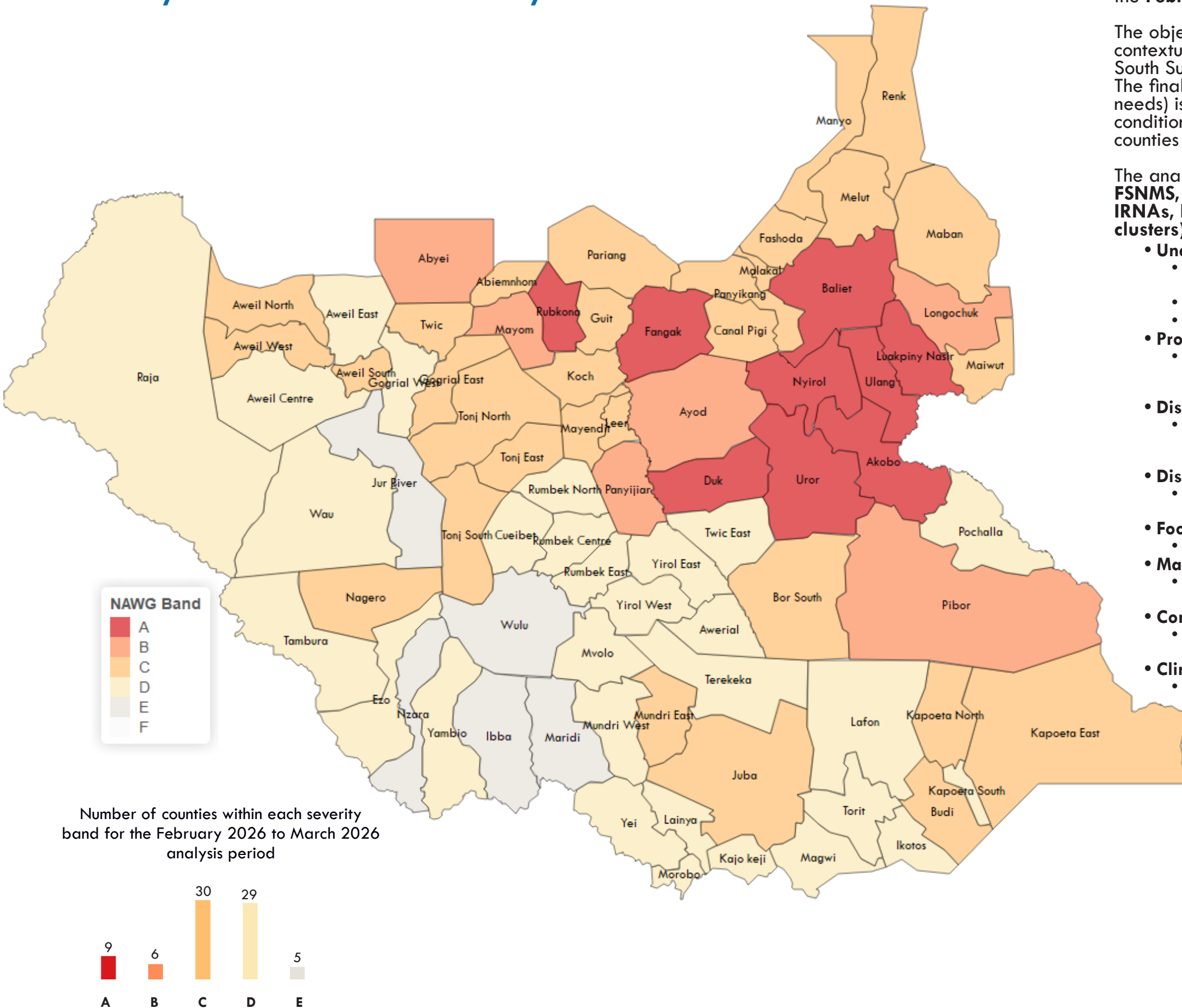


SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

February 2026 – March 2026 Analysis



Background

The NAWG meeting was held on April 14, 2026 to discuss the analysis of the **February 2026 to March 2026** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The analysis encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, ACLED, INSO, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals have the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.
- **Conflict**
 - Armed conflict events, conflict-related sexual violence, forced recruitment of children, targeted killings of civilians, targeted property destruction
- **Climate shocks**
 - Flood-related displacement, flood extent, drought stress, rainfall anomalies.

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B	7 - 7.9	Very severe humanitarian conditions
C	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions
D	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
E	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
F	0 - 1.9	None or minor humanitarian conditions

For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa (sanjeewa@un.org) or Mary Langan (mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org).

SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

February 2026 – March 2026 Analysis

The **February to March 2026** analysis classifies **9 counties in Band A (Extreme)**, **6 in Band B (Very Severe)**, **30 in Band C (Severe)**, **29 in Band D (Moderate)**, **5 in Band E (Stressed)**, and **0 in Band F (Minor)**. **An estimated 217,885 people were displaced across the country between February and March 2026**, with displacement concentrated in the conflict-affected counties of Jonglei and Upper Nile. The humanitarian situation in Akobo deteriorated sharply in early March when government forces ordered the closure of the UNMISS Temporary Operating Base and issued an evacuation directive for humanitarian workers and all civilians.

[FEWS NET](#) estimates that up to **8.0-8.99 million people will need humanitarian food assistance to prevent widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and worse outcomes through September 2026**, with needs peaking from July to September. **Furthermore, there is a credible risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in Nasir and Ulang (Upper Nile) and in Ayod, Duk, Nyirol, Uror, Akobo, and Fangak (Jonglei)**. Levels of hunger and acute malnutrition are already high, with levels of acute malnutrition expected to surpass the “Extremely Critical” threshold by July in some counties, particularly as cholera incidence surges during the rainy season. If conflict escalates and isolates populations, preventing movement and access to local food sources and humanitarian assistance for a prolonged period, then Famine (IPC Phase 5) would likely occur in these counties. The period of greatest concern is the upcoming lean and flooding seasons (June–September).

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

9 counties were classified as having **extreme humanitarian needs (Band A)** during this analysis period. These counties are **Ulang, Nasir, Rubkona, Fangak, Duk, Baliet, Uror, Nyirol, and Akobo**.

Most of these counties are located in [Jonglei and Upper Nile](#) and are facing compounded challenges, including ongoing conflict, high protection risks, significant population displacement, and severe disease burdens.

Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Nyirol:** An estimated 36,189 people were displaced, the highest of any county nationally. A major IDP concentration at Chuil reached 10,538 verified individuals in early March. Widespread conflict-related sexual violence, child recruitment by armed actors, and very limited access to clinical management of rape persist. Humanitarian access to key locations such as Nyatim, where approximately 30,000 people are concentrated, remains blocked, and the upcoming IPC is expected to declare a risk of Famine. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**

- **Akobo:** The situation in Akobo continued to deteriorate during this reporting period. On 6 March, government forces issued a 72-hour ultimatum for peacekeepers, humanitarian organisations and civilians to evacuate. An assessment conducted between 30 March and 2 April found all 15 health facilities non-functional, with 95% of health workers having fled and the county hospital stripped of equipment. Nearly 200,000 people have been displaced from Akobo, with approximately 100,000 crossing into Ethiopia. Markets have been destroyed and humanitarian offices extensively looted. Humanitarian response inside Akobo is assessed as not feasible, and the county faces a credible risk of Famine. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**
- **Uror:** An estimated 32,589 people were displaced, the second-highest nationally. Cholera resurgence was reported with new cases and deaths, and the latest IPC assesses malnutrition rates above the famine threshold, projecting Uror to be classified in IPC AMN Phase 5 with 5% of the population in IPC AFI Phase 5. Supply prepositioning was heavily impacted by the conflict, and the incoming rainy season is likely to further constrain humanitarian food assistance delivery in June to July 2026. **Final classification: Elevated to Band A.**
- **Ayod:** An estimated 5,489 people were newly displaced during the reporting period, adding to previously identified concentrations. The cholera outbreak continued, with 149 cumulative cases and 19 deaths as of early March. The first humanitarian convoy was dispatched to Ayod and surrounding locations with 160 MT of WASH and nutrition supplies, placing Ayod in a slightly better position than Uror and Nyirol. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Longochuk:** Opposition forces continue to hold territory captured in January. Between 22 and 24 March, government air assets conducted multiple aerial bombardments targeting suspected opposition positions in Udier and Chotbora payams; the strikes reportedly killed livestock and wounded several individuals. A planned food distribution was cancelled due to aerial bombardment, and a new assessment is being prepared. Over 8,000 people are reported displaced according to local authorities as of 13 April. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Abyei:** Escalating intercommunal violence has continued, including a cattle raid in Dumboloya that killed 15 community members. Abyei is also reportedly becoming a refuelling location for cross-border armed actors, with needs increasing and reduced freedom of movement. Displacement from Abiemnhom continues to arrive in Abyei; access and partner presence remain sufficient to maintain current classification. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**

- **Canal/Pigi:** Government and opposition forces engaged in a series of armed confrontations across Atar, Diel, and Korwai payams during the first half of March. An estimated 4,068 people were displaced. The situation remains extremely concerning with very high food prices, though the county remains accessible and no mass displacement has been reported. A recent IPC risk of famine analysis reached a negative conclusion for this cycle. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Mundri East:** An estimated 8,320 people were displaced, among the top ten nationally. An assessment on 24 March documented 1,825 households (10,956 individuals) displaced across seven sites following incidents on 18 and 20 March in which cattle raiders from neighbouring areas killed at least 22 people and raided cattle. Minga payam remains a contested hotspot, and IPC analysis is expected to reflect a deterioration in the share of populations in Phase 3+. **Final classification: Elevated to Band C.**
- **Tonj North:** An estimated 5,384 people were displaced in this reporting period. Inter-communal violence persists, and conditions are projected to deteriorate due to rising food insecurity and malnutrition. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C, added to close monitoring.**
- **Mayom:** Cross-state cattle raids between Mayom and neighbouring Warrap communities remain a persistent driver of inter-communal violence. Unusually high March flooding was detected (32 km²), atypical for the pre-rainy season. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Panyijiar:** A representative public-health survey conducted across multiple displacement sites in February revealed catastrophic levels of hunger, widespread child morbidity, an alarming malnutrition rate, and a crude mortality rate exceeding emergency thresholds. The latest IPC reflects a deterioration with almost three-quarters of households experiencing life-threatening food insecurity. A cholera outbreak and flooding concerns compound the situation, with reports of people dying from starvation. **Final classification: Elevated to Band B.**
- **Maiwut:** A recent SMART survey found a GAM rate of 16.4%, which corroborates the IPC Phase 4 acute malnutrition classification. Climate forecasts indicate the county is likely to receive above normal rains between April and June 2026, raising concerns about compound shocks. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties are flagged for close monitoring: **Nasir, Ulang, Fangak, Baliet, Rubkona, Duk, Akobo, Nyirol, Uror** due to the credible risk of Famine affecting populations across Jonglei and Upper Nile. **Pibor, Lainya, Tonj North, Tonj East, and Nagero** have been placed under closer monitoring due to escalating inter-communal violence, high fatalities, and humanitarian concerns.